CREDIT & COLLECTIONS · TEAM PLAYBOOK

The Westline Collections Playbook

How a new specialist reaches full productivity in 30 days, and how the whole desk stays there.

Westline Auto Parts · Four yards in California · October 2026

Westline is fictional; every figure comes from a synthetic dataset

WHAT THE PLAYBOOK DELIVERED

Every specialist measure moved after the training

Dials per specialist per day

49 → 85

Calls that reach the person who pays

22.6% → 29.6%

Promises paid on the promised date

71.6% → 82.2%

Call quality score, out of 100

73 → 90

A specialist hired in August on this playbook was making **79 dials a day by week 5**, the same pace as the experienced team.

Rohit Verma and Ananya Desai, January vs October 2026. Training began 2 March 2026. Synthetic data.

THE STANDARD

Seven measures define a fully productive specialist

Measure	Target	How it is measured
Dials per day	80	Outbound calls logged per working day
Right-party contact	30%	Calls that reach the person who can pay, divided by dials
Promises kept	80%	Promises paid in full by the promised date
Quality score	85	Two calls a week, scored out of 100
Calls logged	100%	Every call has a disposition form entry
First contact on requests	4 hours	From another team’s request to the first customer call
Card ask over $1,500	Every call	Checked when calls are scored

Targets live on the Settings tab of the AR Operating Workbook.

THE FIRST 30 DAYS

Dials build week by week, and so does the work

WEEK 1

30

dials a day

Shadow live calls. Learn the workbook. First calls on accounts just past due.

Actual: 28

WEEK 2

50

dials a day

Own small balances. First promise follow-ups.

Actual: 50

WEEK 3

65

dials a day

Full queue under $1,500. Disputes logged and handed on.

Actual: 64

WEEK 4

75

dials a day

Card asks over $1,500. First escalation, with the Lead listening.

Actual: 75

WEEK 5

80

dials a day

Full queue, all accounts. Day-30 sign-off with the Lead.

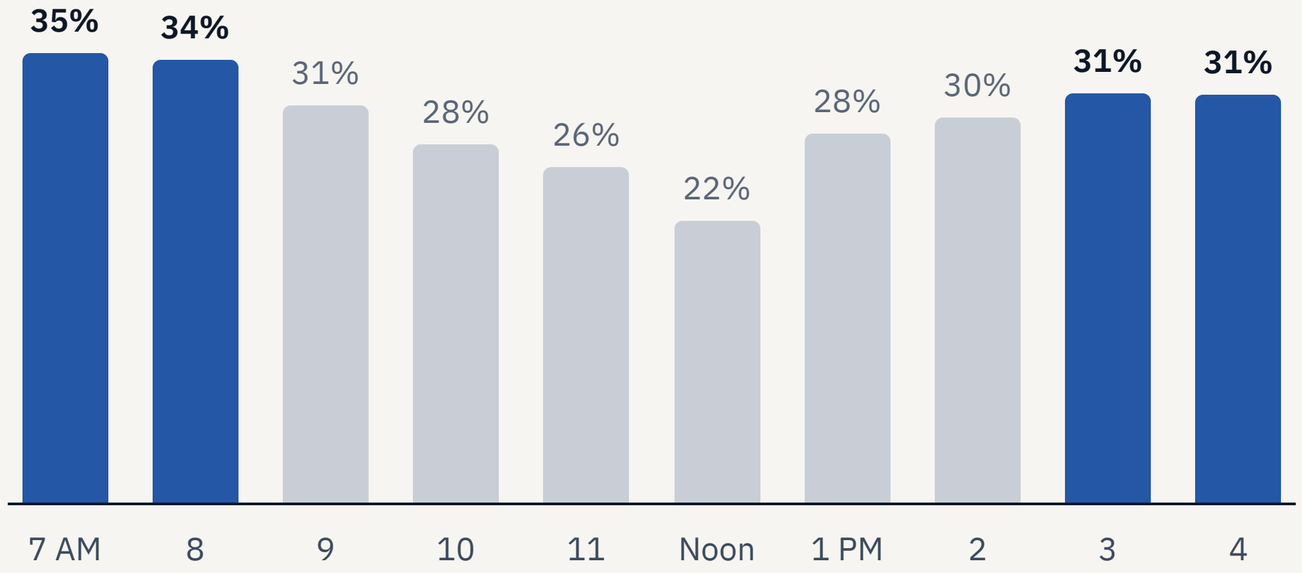
Actual: 79

Actual = Kabir Singh, who joined on 3 August 2026, average dials per day in each week. Synthetic data.

HOW THE DAY RUNS

Call when shops pick up: 7 to 9 AM and 3 to 5 PM Pacific

Calls that reached the person who pays, by hour, May to October 2026



7–9 AM · Power block
Top of the Work Queue, biggest balances first

9–11 AM · Follow-ups
Promises due today and booked callbacks

11 AM–1 PM · Desk work
Requests, disputes, emails, logging

1–3 PM · Second pass
Retry the morning’s no-answers

3–5 PM · Power block
Card asks and key accounts

Hours in Pacific time. India is 12 h 30 min ahead in US summer and 13 h 30 min ahead in winter. Synthetic data.

THE CALL FRAMEWORK

Every call follows the same six steps

1 Open

Your name, the company and the reason, in one breath.

“Hi, this is Rohit from Westline Auto Parts, about your account.”

2 Verify

Make sure you have the person who approves payment.

“Are you the right person for payables at the shop?”

3 State

The exact balance, the oldest invoice and how late it is.

“You have $2,184.50 open; the oldest invoice is from 12 August.”

4 Ask

Ask for payment today. Then stop talking and wait.

“Can we take care of that today by card?”

5 Commit

Agree the amount, the date, the method and who will pay.

“So $2,184.50 by ACH on Friday the 30th, from you, Maria?”

6 Confirm

Repeat it back, email it, and log the call before the next one.

“I’ll email that to you now. Thanks, Maria.”

Names and amounts in the example lines are illustrations.

SCRIPT

The first call on a past-due account

YOU Hi, this is Ananya from Westline Auto Parts. Who looks after payables at Delta Collision?

SHOP That’s me, Maria.

YOU Thanks, Maria. I’m calling about $1,286.40 open on your account. The oldest invoice is from 12 August, so it’s 46 days late. Can we take care of it today?

SHOP I thought we paid that.

YOU Let me check while we talk. Do you have a check number or a date? I’ll trace it with our cash team today and call you back by 3 PM.

If they say…

“We already paid”

Get the check number and date. Cash application traces it the same day.

“That charge is wrong”

Log a dispute. Calls stop on that invoice only.

“I can’t pay it all”

Take part today and date the rest. Two dates at most.

No answer

Leave your name, number, the invoice and one sentence. Then email the statement.

Names and amounts are illustrations.

SCRIPT

Over $1,500 past due? Lead with a card payment

19% → 38%

Share of the specialists’ collections paid by card, January vs October 2026

> “The quickest way to clear this is a card payment today. I can take it now and email you the receipt. Which card would you like to use?”
>
> *If they hesitate: “If the full amount is too much for one card, we can do part now and set a date for the rest.”*

- Ask for the card before you explain anything else.
- Key the card straight into the payment terminal. Never write it down, and confirm only the last four digits aloud.
- Email the receipt before the call ends.

Rohit Verma and Ananya Desai combined. The $1,500 threshold is set on the workbook’s Settings tab. Synthetic data.

OBJECTIONS

Five objections, and what to say back

They say	It usually means	You say
“The check is in the mail.”	Not paid yet, or paid and not applied	“Great. What’s the check number and the date it went out? I’ll watch for it and call you Thursday if it hasn’t arrived.”
“AP only pays on Thursdays.”	A real payment cycle	“Then let’s get it into this Thursday’s run. Can you confirm the amount that will go out?”
“We never got the invoice.”	A paperwork gap	“I’ll email it now while we’re talking. Can you tell me when it arrives?”
“The part was defective.”	A possible return or dispute	“I’ll log that and start the return now. The rest of the balance isn’t affected. Can we clear that part today?”
“We’re waiting on our own customer.”	Cash is tight	“I understand. What can you pay today, and what date works for the rest?”

Every answer ends with a question that asks for a number or a date.

PROMISES

A promise counts only when it has all four parts

Amount

Not “most of it”

“$1,200 today”

Date

Not “end of the month”

“Friday 30 October”

Method

Not “we’ll send it”

“ACH” or “card”

Who

Not “someone in the office”

“Maria, in AP”

Missed

Call the next business day. The Work Queue raises it as a Promise follow-up.

Missed twice in 90 days

No more promises. A card payment today, or the Lead reviews the account.

Paid in part

The rest gets its own date before you hang up.

Promises kept rose from 71.6% in January 2026 to 82.2% in October once all four parts became mandatory. Synthetic data.

THE WORK QUEUE

The queue picks the next action; you work it top-down

Next action	When it appears	What you do
Promise follow-up	A promised date passed unpaid	Call today; new date or card now
Resolve dispute	A dispute is open on the account	Send papers to the Lead; no ask on it
Call – request card payment	Over $1,500 past due	Lead with the card ask
Send demand letter	60+ days late, 14 days without contact	Lead approves; email and mail it
Small-claims review	90+ days late, 21 days without contact	Lead prepares; Controller approves
Key-account reconciliation	Group account with several locations	Lead reconciles one statement
Call	Any other past-due account	The six-step call

Ranking weights: amount 40 · days late 22 · broken promises 12 · days since contact 12 · risk 14

ESCALATIONS

Acknowledge, own, fix, confirm

1

Acknowledge

Thank them, and repeat the problem back in their words.

2

Own

Give your name and a time you will call back. Never pass them around.

3

Fix

Log it on the request log. The team that owns it acts within 4 hours.

4

Confirm

Call back when you said you would, confirm it is fixed, and log it.

Hand it to the Lead when

- The amount is over $5,000, or the account is a key account
- The customer mentions a lawyer or legal action
- Anything looks like fraud (next slide)
- It is the account’s second escalation in 30 days

5.8 → 2.6

median days to resolve an escalation, Apr–Dec 2025 vs May–Oct 2026

430 escalations logged since April 2025. Synthetic data.

FRAUD

Four red flags: pause and tell the Lead

A new ship-to address on a big order

Over $1,000 to an address we have never shipped to: confirm on the number on file before it leaves the yard.

A request to change where payments go

Confirm by phone with a known contact before anything changes. Westline never changes bank details by email.

A customer who paid someone else

Take the details, tell the Lead, and resend our real remittance details from the system.

A card in a name not on the account

Stop the payment and check with the account owner first.

Since April 2025: **26 broker orders** that never arrived, and **22 customers who paid an impersonator**.

From the escalation log. Full analysis in the Chargeback and Refund Root-Cause Map. Synthetic data.

CALLING US SHOPS

Be clear, warm and quick

Sound clear

- Short sentences, one point each, at an easy pace.
- Say money in full: “two thousand one hundred eighty-four dollars and fifty cents.”
- Say dates the US way, with the day: “Friday, October 30.”

Sound like a partner

- Use their first name once they give it.
- One line of small talk, then the reason for the call.
- Close warmly: “Thanks, Maria. Have a good one.”

Know their calendar

- Work in Pacific time, and call in the two power blocks.
- Plan around US holidays: July 4, Labor Day, Thanksgiving, Christmas.
- Many shops pay on a weekly AP run. Ask which day, and time your follow-up to it.

The US call-handling training began on 2 March 2026.

QUALITY SCORECARD

Two calls a week, scored out of 100

Area	Points	What earns full points
Opening and verification	15	Name, company and reason; payer confirmed before the balance
Balance stated clearly	15	Exact amount, oldest invoice and days late
The ask	20	Payment asked for today; card first above $1,500
Commitment	20	Amount, date, method and name, repeated back
Tone and accuracy	15	Calm and courteous, no threats, nothing untrue
Logging and next step	15	Form done before the next dial; follow-up set

85 or more meets the standard. **Under 75** means coaching that week. A threat, a wrong balance stated as fact, or an unlogged promise scores **zero** for the call.

The team average rose from 73 in January 2026 to 90 in October. Synthetic data.

COACHING RHYTHM

Coach one behaviour at a time, on a fixed rhythm

DAILY

10-minute huddle

Before the first power block: yesterday’s numbers, today’s promises due, one tip.

WEEKLY

30-minute one-to-one

Play back the two scored calls. Agree one thing to change next week.

MONTHLY

Calibration

Everyone scores the same three calls. Scores should land within 5 points of each other.

DAY 30

Sign-off

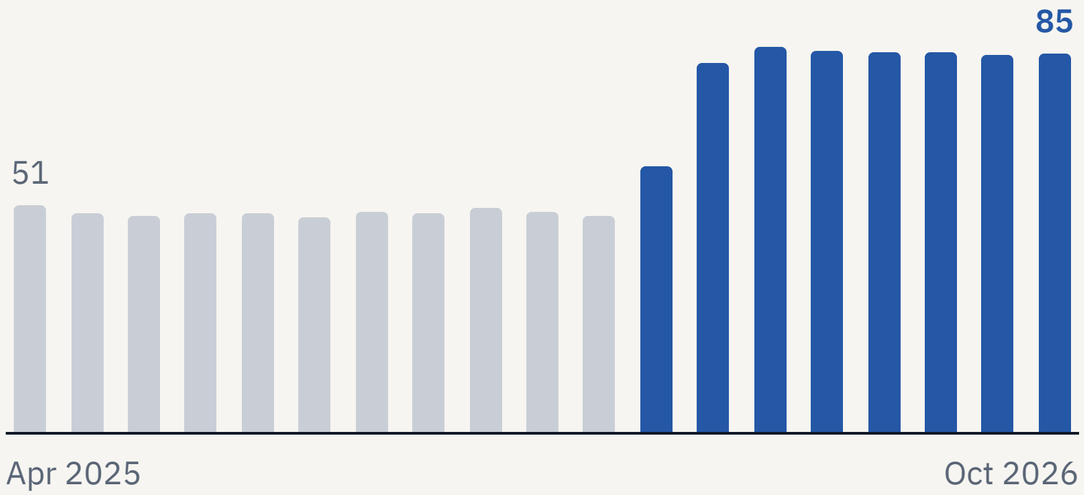
The Lead signs off a new specialist against the checklist, then moves them to monthly reviews.

The Lead runs every session; specialists bring their own call recordings.

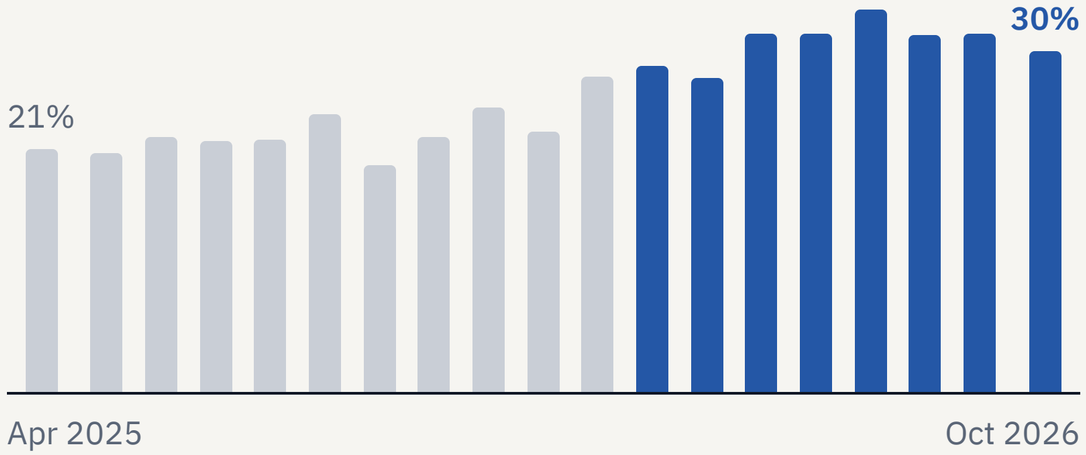
RESULTS

Dials and contact rate rose together after the March training

Dials per specialist per day



Calls that reach the person who pays



Grey: before training. Blue: from March 2026. Monthly averages for Rohit Verma and Ananya Desai. Synthetic data.

DAY-30 SIGN-OFF

Eight things a specialist shows before working alone

- 80 dials a day for five days in a row
- 28% or more of calls reach the payer, two weeks running
- Quality score of 85 or more on the last four scored calls
- Every call logged, and every promise with all four parts
- A card ask on every balance over $1,500
- One escalation handled end to end, with the Lead listening
- Explains each Work Queue action and when it appears
- Names the four fraud red flags and who to tell

Specialist: _____ Collections Lead: _____ Date: _____

Kept with the specialist’s training record.

Collect the cash.
Keep the customer.

Every rule in this playbook serves both, because the shop that pays today is the shop that orders tomorrow.